Russia), hoped to host the new institution, but it yielded to China's greater economic and financial power resources and agreed to the NDB headquarters being sited in Shanghai. Both India and Brazil strongly insisted that initial capital subscriptions, and thus voting shares, be equally allocated among the five countries. According to Indian sources, China argued in favor of a permanent NDB presidency for itself, rather than the rotating one ultimately chosen, but was persuaded to back down on this demand.[205] Moreover, India was granted the right to appoint the NDB's first president, while each of the other countries would appoint a vice president, and in 2014, Prime Minister Modi selected a prominent private banker, K. V. Kamath, for this role. Kamath was then the chair of Industrial Credit and Investment Corporation of India Bank (ICICI), the country's most successful private bank, a formerly public-sector bank that was privatized in stages through the 1990s. ICICI's management strategy has focused on serving large, internationally oriented Indian businesses and foreign multinationals operating within India: The bank charges above-market prices for better service, a somewhat revolutionary strategy in Indian financial markets, where public-sector banks still hold 70 percent of deposits. By nominating Kamath, India's leaders signaled the seriousness with which they were treating the creation of the BRICS' new financial institutions.

Resisting the West's Abuse of International Financial Clout

Indian policymakers clearly favor a redistribution of both financial market and financial regulatory capabilities to the emerging economies. Many Indian elite observers are alert to evidence that the dominant financial powers are incompetent, and they feel confident that they could do at least as good a job.[206] Policy-attentive elites have been particularly incensed by the U.S. (and Western) tendency to employ its position as the undisputed global financial hegemon since World War II as a general-purpose power capability to be used in pursuit of larger U.S. foreign policy aims. First, Indians complain that the West, but especially the United States, wields its financial power irresponsibly. India itself has been harmed on two recent occasions by U.S. financial sanctions. After India's detonation of an underground nuclear device in 1998, the United States imposed trade sanctions on India due to India's unwillingness to join the nuclear weapons